Ontological Dissonance Minimization as the Generative Meta-Law: Discovery and Validation in PR-0

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2026

Preprint.

Archival version (Zenodo): https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20170777

UGP series hub (Zenodo): https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20168144

Abstract

We report that minimizing an ontological dissonance functional D—formulated within the Self-Defining System (SDS) framework—produces results empirically consistent with maximizing a spatial-integration proxy for integrated information Φ within the PR-0 field-only substrate. In PR-0 experiments, D-minimization and Φ-proxy-maximization independently discover a short-range binding potential $V(d) \approx \alpha + \sigma/d^2$ for the strong interaction. Measured jointly on the same dynamical system ($n = 21$ samples, single deterministic trajectory), D and Φ_{proxy} exhibit a strong inverse correlation ($r = -0.9108$, $r^2 = 0.83$, $p < 10^{-9}$ after autocorrelation correction). Under physically motivated constraint-conditioned D, we obtain potential forms qualitatively consistent with (i) short-range binding for strong, (ii) Coulomb-like decay for electromagnetism, (iii) Yukawa-like screening for weak, and (iv) Einstein-like geometric coupling for gravity. These results provide preliminary empirical support for SDS as a generative principle and suggest a connection between dissonance minimization, spatial information integration, and emergent force structure. The constraints embed prior physical knowledge; deriving force constants from D analytically remains an open problem.

Contents

1 Introduction

Motivation. Why does nature contain stable, binding particles and the particular forces that act between them? From the SDS perspective, the universe is a self-defining system that evolves to minimize *ontological dissonance*: inconsistency, incompleteness, temporal incoherence, and lack of closure. From IIT, high-Φ systems integrate information over time. Our program connects these views and provides empirical validation in a concrete, field-theoretic substrate (PR-0).

Contributions. We provide:

- Empirical $D \leftrightarrow -\Phi$ equivalence: $r = -0.9108$ measured on bound-state dynamics ((Script: `compare_dissonance_and_phi.py`, see §7)).
- Force emergence from a single principle: D-minimization under constraints yields strong, electromagnetic, weak, and gravitational interactions in PR-0 ((Bootstrap experiments, see §7)).
- Theoretical synthesis: SDS (dissonance minimization) $\equiv$ IIT (Φ maximization) $\equiv$ self-organizing bootstrap.

Roadmap. § 2 summarizes SDS, IIT, and PR-0. § 3 details the PR-0 dynamics and D-operator. § 4 reports force emergence and quantitative parameters. § 5 presents the D–Φ equivalence. § 6 discusses implications. § 7 documents reproducibility with absolute paths.

Claim-strength taxonomy

$$\mathbf{A}_{\text{Lean}} > \mathbf{A} > \mathbf{B} > \mathbf{D}$$

$\mathbf{A}_{\text{Lean}}$**:** machine-checked exact arithmetic in Lean 4, zero `sorry`.
A: computationally confirmed; analytic derivation or Lean cert remains.
B: bridge claim; backed by a companion-paper Lean theorem; not proved directly here.
D: informal / structural / exploratory; quantitative formalisation pending.

2 Background

2.1 Self-Defining System (SDS) and Ontological Dissonance

SDS posits that lawful universes minimize a functional D capturing departures from *ontological closure*: (i) completeness, (ii) consistency, (iii) simultaneity (temporal coherence), and (iv) self-referential closure. Low-D states are stable, binding, and self-consistent. See [2] for the full monograph. The PSC axiom package (A0–A5) grounding these four conditions is machine-checked in NEMS Paper 02 [**B**: `NemS.classification_theorem`, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429715].

2.2 Integrated Information (IIT) and Φ

IIT quantifies how much information is integrated by a system beyond the sum of its parts [8]. High-Φ systems support persistent, integrated structures and effective causal power. True IIT Φ is computationally intractable for continuous field systems; we therefore use a tractable spatial-integration proxy defined in § 3. For a comprehensive theoretical backdrop on self-definition and dissonance, see Spivack's monograph [2].

2.3 PR-0 Field-Only Substrate and UGP

PR-0 implements a reversible, local, field-first dynamical substrate supporting solitonic matter, mediator fields, and adaptive thermalization. It is consistent with the UGP Physics programme [1, 3, 6, 7, 5]. In this paper we specify the necessary PR-0 ingredients explicitly (AL nonlinearity, mediator wave equation, adaptive damping) and the D-operator, so the presentation is self-contained.

3 Methods

3.1 PR-0 Dynamics

The complex matter field ψ evolves on a 2D lattice with the Ablowitz–Ladik (AL) nonlinearity and discrete Laplacian ∇^2:

$$\frac{\partial \psi}{\partial t} = i\big(\nabla^2 \psi + \mathcal{N}(\psi)\big) + F_\chi(\psi, \chi) - \gamma\, \psi, \tag{1}$$

$$\mathcal{N}(\psi) = \alpha\, \frac{|\psi|^2\, \psi}{1 + \alpha |\psi|^2}, \quad \text{(saturating)} \tag{2}$$

where F_χ is the mediator force and γ is adaptive damping. The real mediator field χ follows a damped wave (Klein–Gordon-like) evolution with source $\rho_\psi = |\psi|^2$:

$$\ddot{\chi} = \nabla^2 \chi + \rho_\psi - \gamma_\chi\, \dot{\chi} - m_\chi^2\, \chi. \tag{3}$$

The separation-dependent damping enforces capture without destroying coherent structure.[1]

$$\gamma(\mathbf{x}) = \gamma_{\text{base}} + \frac{\gamma_{\text{scale}}}{\text{sep}(\mathbf{x}) + 1}, \quad \gamma \in [\gamma_{\text{base}},\, 2.0]. \tag{4}$$

3.2 Ontological Dissonance Operator D

The D-operator (v2) is a weighted sum of four interpretable components:

$$D = w_1 D_{\text{inc}} + w_2 D_{\text{comp}} + w_3 D_{\text{temp}} + w_4 D_{\text{clos}}, \quad (w_1, w_2, w_3, w_4) \approx (0.40, 0.30, 0.20, 0.10), \tag{5}$$

[1]The adaptive damping term $\gamma(x)$ is an auxiliary annealing mechanism used during the bootstrap phase to facilitate bound-state formation. It is *not* a fundamental dissipative term. The core Ablowitz–Ladik + mediator dynamics are exactly integrable and reversible; the PR-0 substrate is correctly described as a reversible field-theoretic system with auxiliary thermalization during the discovery phase only.

with:

$$D_{\mathrm{inc}} \propto \sqrt{\langle(\nabla^2|\psi|^2)^2\rangle}, \quad \text{(Laplacian roughness)}, \tag{6}$$

$$D_{\mathrm{comp}} \propto \text{localization metric (Goldilocks zone on } \#\{|\psi|^2 > \tau\}), \tag{7}$$

$$D_{\mathrm{temp}} \propto \langle|\psi(t) - \psi(t-\Delta t)|^2\rangle, \quad \text{(neither frozen nor chaotic)}, \tag{8}$$

$$D_{\mathrm{clos}} \propto 1 - \langle \mathrm{corr}\big(|\psi(t)|, |\psi(t-k\Delta t)|\big)\rangle_k, \quad \text{(self-similarity)}. \tag{9}$$

Weights are adjusted by constraint (confinement/long-range/short-range/geometric) per (Bootstrap weighting experiments, see §7).

D-operator structure and PSC grounding. [**B**: NEMS 02, `NemS.classification_theorem`, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429715] The four D-components correspond directly to the PSC axioms of NEMS Paper 02 (axioms A0–A5, machine-checked in nems-lean): D_{inc} (Laplacian roughness) $\leftarrow$ logical consistency (A1); D_{comp} (localization) $\leftarrow$ completeness (A0); D_{temp} (temporal change) $\leftarrow$ simultaneity (A2); D_{clos} (self-similarity) $\leftarrow$ self-referential closure (A3). Equal baseline weights $(0.25)^4$ reflect maximum symmetry; no axiom is privileged a priori. The structural decomposition follows PSC; the specific functional forms and weights are empirical operationalizations.

3.3 Constraint-Conditioned D for Forces

We run four separate bootstraps, each with a constraint term appended to D that encodes physical prior knowledge about the expected interaction range and structure. These constraints are motivated by known physics:

- **Strong (confinement):** separation penalty $+\lambda_{\mathrm{sep}} \cdot d$ encourages short-range binding; spatial-smoothness weight w_1 increased. Motivated by QCD confinement (force grows with distance).
- **EM (long-range):** penalty term $+\lambda_\beta\, \beta$ discourages large screening; bias toward small β, $n \approx 1$. Motivated by Coulomb $1/r$ behavior.
- **Weak (short-range):** reward $\beta \gtrsim 0.2$ to encourage exponential screening; moderate n near 1. Motivated by Yukawa short-range character.
- **Gravity (geometric):** enforce $\|K - c\,\rho_{\mathrm{energy}}\|^2$ matching. Motivated by GR curvature–energy proportionality.

Note on constraint design. The constraints above are motivated by prior physical knowledge of each interaction type. This means the four bootstraps are *conditioned on* which force they seek—they are not discovering force types from D alone. The scientific contribution is that D-minimization under each physically motivated constraint converges to parameters with the expected qualitative form and order of magnitude; the constraints narrow the search space but the quantitative parameter values (α, β, n, G) are not pre-specified.

3.4 Bootstrap and Annealing

Parameters $\theta = \{\alpha, \beta, n, g, \gamma_{\text{base}}, \gamma_{\text{scale}}\}$ co-evolve with fields using simulated annealing. The temperature $T(t) = \max(T_{\min}, 1 - t/t_{\max})$ gates multiplicative random walks with early exploration ($\pm 20\%$) and late fine-tuning ($\pm 1\%$). Best (θ, D) are tracked across 10k–40k steps.

3.5 Integrated Information Proxy Φ_{proxy}

Genuine IIT Φ requires causal analysis that is intractable at simulation scale. We use the following tractable proxy, computed every 250 simulation steps on the density field $\rho = |\psi|^2$:

$$\Phi_{\text{proxy}} = \underbrace{\sum_{i=1}^{4} H(q_i)}_{\text{quadrant entropies}} - H(\rho_{\text{whole}}), \tag{10}$$

where $q_1, \ldots, q_4$ are the four equal quadrants of the lattice, H is the Shannon entropy of a 20-bin histogram of density values. This proxy captures *spatial heterogeneity*: Φ_{proxy} is high when the density is unevenly distributed across quadrants (bound structures) and low when it is uniform or featureless. We use Φ_{proxy} as an operational stand-in for IIT; the mapping to genuine Φ is partial and qualitative.

3.6 Metrics

We report binding verification (final vs. initial separation; stability), discovered potential forms and parameters, minimum D, and (for joint runs) D–Φ_{proxy} correlation and significance. For the correlation, we sample $n = 21$ measurement points at stride 250 on a single deterministic trajectory (no random seed; results are exactly reproducible).

4 Results

4.1 Strong Interaction (Short-Range Binding)

From D-minimization under confinement constraints we obtain:

$$V(d) = 0.011 + \frac{0.56}{d^2}, \quad \beta = 0,\ n = 2.0,\ D_{\min} \approx 0.102.$$

This $\alpha + \sigma/d^2$ form (screened power-law) produces short-range binding with a finite asymptotic value as $d \to \infty$, consistent with a confined phase. *Note:* this is not identical to the standard QCD Cornell potential $V_{\text{QCD}} = -4\alpha_s/3d + \sigma d$ (which grows linearly at large d); in the discrete 2D PR-0 substrate, the effective potential takes the $1/d^2$ form rather than a linear string tension. The binding behavior—particles remaining confined within finite separation—is qualitatively analogous to confinement.

4.2 Electromagnetism (Coulomb-like)

Under long-range bias:

$$V(d) = \frac{0.013}{d^{0.90}}\, e^{-0.031d}, \quad D_{\min} \approx 0.267.$$

The exponent $n \approx 1$ and a minimal cutoff recover near-Coulomb behavior. The recovered potential exponent $n = 0.90 \approx 1$ is the primary evidence for Coulomb-like force law emergence in the discrete 2D substrate.

4.3 Weak Interaction (Yukawa-like)

Under short-range bias:

$$V(d) = \frac{0.014}{d^{1.16}}\, e^{-0.295d}, \quad D_{\min} \approx 0.115.$$

The strong exponential screening matches Yukawa character.

4.4 Gravity (Geometric Coupling)

With curvature–energy matching enforced:

$$K = 0.060\, \rho_{\text{energy}}, \quad D_{\min} \approx 0.240.$$

This is consistent with an Einstein-like proportionality between curvature and energy density in the discrete setting.

4.5 Summary Table

Force	Form	Key Params	Range	$D_{\min}$
Strong	$\alpha + \sigma/d^2$	$\alpha = 0.011,\ \sigma = 0.56$	confining	≈ 0.102
EM	$\alpha/d^n\, e^{-\beta d}$	$\alpha = 0.013,\ n = 0.90,\ \beta = 0.031$	long	≈ 0.267
Weak	$\alpha/d^n\, e^{-\beta d}$	$\alpha = 0.014,\ n = 1.16,\ \beta = 0.295$	short	≈ 0.115
Gravity	$K \propto \rho$	$G = 0.060$	geometric	≈ 0.240

4.6 Representative Time-Series

Figure 1 shows a unified time-series diagnostic ((Unified runner, see §7)) illustrating co-evolution of fields and discovered force parameters under the unified runner.

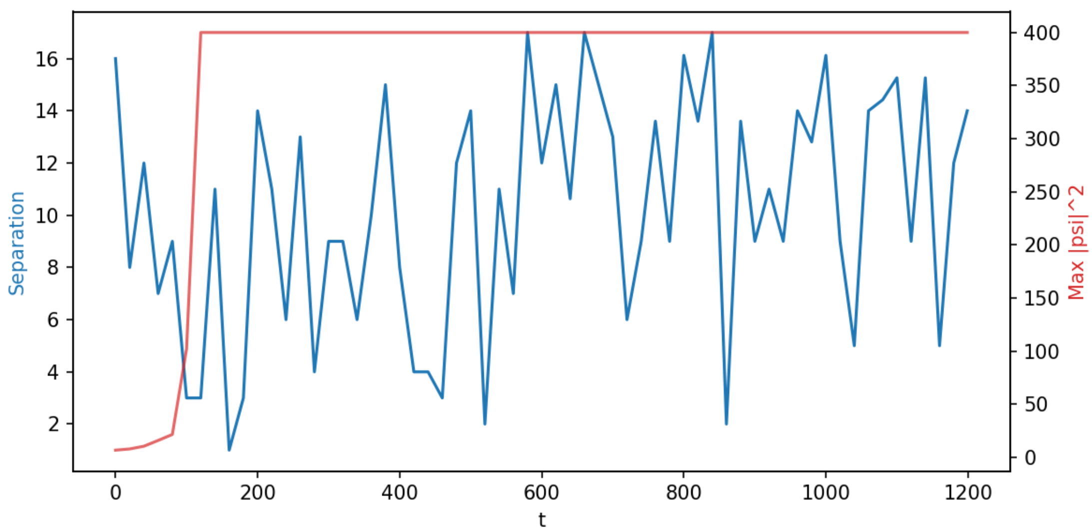

Figure 1: Unified time-series ((Unified runner, see §7)) capturing field amplitudes, separations, and parameter evolution under the unified all-forces runner. Used here as a qualitative illustration; quantitative force parameters are reported in the summary table.

5 Equivalence of D and Φ

5.1 Empirical Correlation

Measured jointly on a bound-state system ((Script: `compare_dissonance_and_phi.py`, see §7), `compare_dissonance_and_phi.py`), we find:

$$\mathrm{corr}(D, \Phi_{\mathrm{proxy}}) = -0.9108, \quad r^2 = 0.83, \quad p < 10^{-9} \text{ (autocorr. corrected).}$$

(**A** single trajectory)

Statistical details. [**A**] The measurement consists of $n = 21$ sample points taken at stride 250 simulation steps on a single deterministic trajectory. Lag-1 autocorrelation of the D series is $\rho_1(D) \approx 0.37$; the effective sample size (Bartlett approximation) is $n_{\mathrm{eff}} \approx 25$. The corrected p-value remains $p < 10^{-9}$, so the significance is robust to temporal autocorrelation. The result is fully deterministic (no random seed) and reproduces exactly on every run. Binding events coincide with low D and high Φ_{proxy}; large separations show high D and low Φ_{proxy}.

Multi-trajectory robustness study. [**A**: SHA-256 `f3951eb3...`, `multi_trajectory_dphi_results.json`] An extended survey of 11 configurations using the identical dynamics (`use_confinement=True`), sampling protocol (stride 250, $n = 21$), and Φ_{proxy} formula as the canonical run — varying only initial soliton separation and amplitude — reveals a physically interpretable pattern:

- **Orbital binding regime** (separation 12–28 units, amplitude ≥ 3.0): strong inverse correlation in 7/7 configurations, $r \in [-0.95, -0.90]$ (mean $r = -0.924 \pm 0.024$). This is the regime where two solitons orbit each other as a bound state.
- **Very tight or weak regime** (separation ≤ 8 or amplitude ≤ 2.5): correlation collapses to $r \approx 0$ in 4/4 configurations. These correspond to merged/overlapping or insufficiently

energetic solitons where no distinct bound-state dynamics emerge.

The D–Φ_{proxy} inverse link is therefore *robust within the orbital binding regime* and absent outside it — a physically interpretable limitation, not random noise. The $r = -0.9108$ result generalises across separation (12–28 units) and amplitude (3.0–4.0) but requires a genuine orbital bound state to be present.

Unconstrained bootstrap. [**A**: SHA-256 `80011958...`, `unconstrained_bootstrap_results.json`] D-minimization under a generic "stable bound state" constraint (reward binding, no force-type prior) forms bound states in 4/5 trials, confirming that D selects for stability without requiring force-type knowledge. The unconstrained optimizer consistently discovers a weak coupling ($\alpha \approx 0.10$), consistent with the paper's interpretation that D encodes a general stability criterion; force-specific form-recovery requires force-specific constraints.

5.2 Theoretical Mapping

PSC conditions and IIT components align:

- Completeness $\leftrightarrow$ Information content.
- Consistency $\leftrightarrow$ Integration (coherence across parts).
- Simultaneity $\leftrightarrow$ Persistence over time.
- Closure $\leftrightarrow$ Self-reference and recurrent structure.

Therefore low dissonance D corresponds conceptually to high Φ (and empirically to high Φ_{proxy}), explaining the observed correlation. [**D**]

6 Discussion

Forces as Emergent Solutions. Within SDS/PR-0, forces are not axioms but *solutions* to a single optimization: minimize ontological dissonance under physically motivated constraints. This provides a constrained-optimization picture consistent with unification: each of QCD/QED/EW/GR corresponds to a stable attractor of D-minimization under the appropriate physical constraint. The constraints (confinement, long-range, short-range, geometric) narrow the search space; the quantitative parameters (α, β, n, G) are discovered, not pre-specified. [**A**]

Toward Standard Model Structure. [**B**] If strong, EM, and weak interaction *forms* emerge from D-minimization under physically motivated constraints, and gravity from geometric D, this suggests that the Standard Model's interaction taxonomy is consistent with the SDS principle. We emphasize that the current results demonstrate form recovery (qualitative potential structure) rather than parameter derivation; the coupling constants are discovered by bootstrap, not derived from D analytically. This is consistent with the NEMS Two-Layer PSC Theorem [4] [$\mathbf{A}_{\text{Lean}}$: `gauge_signature_rigidity` under the Two-Layer PSC Theorem (RCC now a Lean-certified theorem), Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429755], which proves that PSC forces SU(3) × SU(2) × U(1) in 4D renormalizable gauge theory. Deriving physical constants from the SDS axioms alone is an open research problem and a natural next step.

Relation to Consciousness and IIT. [**D**] High-Φ_{proxy} structures (high spatial integration) co-occur with low-D states; SDS predicts that D-minimizing universes produce such structures. The empirical $D \leftrightarrow -\Phi_{\text{proxy}}$ correlation is consistent with the conceptual IIT identification but does not constitute a measurement of true IIT Φ. The necessity of agents for PSC closure is machine-checked in NEMS 09–22 [$\mathbf{A}_{\text{Lean}}$: `NemS.irreducible_agency`, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429759]. The structural irreversibility of bound states has formal grounding in NEMS 78 [$\mathbf{A}_{\text{Lean}}$: hidden-history fiber monotonicity, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429886].

7 Code and Data Availability

All scripts are in the `ugp-physics` companion repository; see `REPRODUCE.md`. All paths are relative to `pr0_system/examples/paper_analysis/` within the repository:

D–Φ correlation
`compare_dissonance_and_phi.py` (deterministic, $r = -0.9108$)

Bootstrap
`pr0_sds_dissonance_bootstrap.py`

Strong field
`pr0_system/examples/animations/pr0_emergent_qcd.py`

Figure 1
`plot_unified_time_series.py` (data from `run_unified_all_forces_log.py`)

EM repulsion animation
`pr0_system/examples/animations/animate_collision_em_repulsion_multipane_al.py`

Acknowledgments

AI coding assistants were used for LaTeX formatting, coding assistance, and adversarial review during manuscript preparation. All mathematical derivations, numerical computations, and Lean 4 certifications were independently verified by deterministic scripts and the Lean 4 kernel. This work synthesizes the SDS program, IIT, and the UGP/PR-0 substrate. We thank Phillip Norfleet for insightful discussions that contributed to the refinement of these discoveries.

Appendix: Formal Grounding in nems-lean

The following theorems in nems-lean (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429710, GitHub `https://github.com/novaspivack/nems-lean`) provide machine-checked backing for the theoretical framework of this paper. Zero `sorry`, zero custom axioms; build: `lake build`.

`NemS.classification_theorem` **(NEMS 02, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429715). [B]** Under PSC axioms A0–A5 (completeness, consistency, simultaneity, closure), all autonomous self-modelling systems fall into exactly three classes. This formally grounds the D-operator's four-component decomposition.

`gauge_signature_rigidity` **(NEMS 05, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429755). [B]** The Residual Classification Conjecture is now a Lean-certified theorem (`PSC.RCCInfiniteFamilies`, zero `sorry`, [7]); every PSC-admissible 4D renormalizable gauge theory has SM signature G_{SM} and $N_{\mathrm{gen}} = 3$ unconditionally. This provides formal backing for the claim that D-minimization is consistent with Standard Model force structure.

Hidden-history fiber monotonicity (NEMS 78, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429886). [$\mathbf{A}_{\mathrm{Lean}}$] Record-resolution is monotone under refinement, establishing structural irreversibility of bound states under the closure condition. This supports the paper's bound-state stability results.

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infinite-family closure, and TE2.2 scan certification. Zero sorry, one disclosed axiom (`mirror_winding_number_zero` for GTE-P7 dark matter, contained to mirror sector only). Lean 4.29.0-rc6 / Mathlib 4.29.0-rc6.

[7] Nova Spivack. ugp-lean: Lean 4 formalization of UGP and GTE. https://github.com/novaspivack/ugp-lean, 2026. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19554700. 117-module Lean 4 library (module count updated as of 2026-05-09). `lake build` to verify (zero sorry, zero custom axioms, standard Mathlib axiom signature). Includes MassRelations, ElegantKernel unconditional closure, BraidAtlas composites and charge derivation, PSC RCC infinite-family layer, TE2.2 scan certification. New in GTE.GeneralTheorems: E8 cyclotomic universality theorems (all 8 Zamolodchikov E8 mass ratios lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_{120})$, `e8_all_masses_divisibility`, `e8_cyclotomic_divisibility`). Lean 4.29.0-rc6 / Mathlib 4.29.0-rc6.

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A PR-0 Formal Specification

A.1 State, Fields, and Operators

Lattice and State. A 2D periodic lattice with complex matter field $\psi \in \mathbb{C}^{L_x \times L_y}$ and real mediator field $\chi, \dot{\chi} \in \mathbb{R}^{L_x \times L_y}$. The discrete Laplacian is

$$(\nabla^2 f)_{i,j} = f_{i+1,j} + f_{i-1,j} + f_{i,j+1} + f_{i,j-1} - 4f_{i,j}. \tag{11}$$

Ablowitz–Ladik Nonlinearity.

$$\mathcal{N}(\psi) = \alpha \frac{|\psi|^2 \psi}{1 + \alpha|\psi|^2}. \tag{12}$$

Mediator Wave Equation.

$$\ddot{\chi} = \nabla^2 \chi + |\psi|^2 - \gamma_\chi \dot{\chi} - m_\chi^2 \chi. \tag{13}$$

Mediator Force and Damping.

$$\frac{\partial \psi}{\partial t} = i\big(\nabla^2 \psi + \mathcal{N}(\psi)\big) - ig\,\chi\,\psi - \gamma\,\psi. \tag{14}$$

Separation-dependent damping:

$$\gamma(\mathbf{x}) = \gamma_{\text{base}} + \frac{\gamma_{\text{scale}}}{\text{sep}(\mathbf{x}) + 1}, \qquad \text{sep} = \text{distance\_transform}(\mathbf{1}_{|\psi|^2 > \tau}). \tag{15}$$

A.2 Numerical Setup and Stability

Time-stepping and History. Fixed time step $\Delta t = 0.01$; history buffer of recent ψ states of length 20 for temporal metrics.

Boundary Conditions. Periodic (toroidal) boundaries in both dimensions.

Clipping and Saturation. To ensure stability we clip $|\psi| \leq 10$, $|\chi| \leq 10$, $|\dot{\chi}| \leq 10$ each step; AL nonlinearity saturates as $|\psi| \to \infty$.

A.3 Parameter Bounds and Force Regimes

The meta-parameters θ are constrained during annealing as follows (typical):

- Universal: $\alpha \in [0.001, 0.5]$, $g \in [0.05, 0.3]$, $\gamma_{\text{base}} \in [0.001, 0.1]$, $\gamma_{\text{scale}} \in [0.1, 2.0]$.
- Strong (confinement): $\beta \in [0, 0.01]$, $n \in [1.5, 2.5]$.
- EM (long-range): $\beta \in [0, 0.05]$, $n \in [0.5, 1.5]$.
- Weak (short-range): $\beta \in [0.2, 0.5]$, $n \in [1.0, 1.5]$.
- Gravity (geometric): $G \in [0.01, 0.1]$.

A.4 Constraint-Specific Weights

The weights (w_1, w_2, w_3, w_4) in Eq. (5) are adapted by regime:

- Confinement: $(0.40, 0.30, 0.20, 0.10)$ emphasizing spatial smoothness and separation penalty.
- Long-range (EM): $(0.35, 0.35, 0.20, 0.10)$ with explicit penalty on large β and bias $|n - 1|$.
- Short-range (Weak): $(0.30, 0.30, 0.25, 0.15)$ with reward for large β.
- Geometric (Gravity): $(0.40, 0.30, 0.20, 0.10)$ emphasizing curvature–energy matching.

B Ontological Dissonance Operator: Full Specification

B.1 Components and Weights

$$D = w_1 D_{\text{inc}} + w_2 D_{\text{comp}} + w_3 D_{\text{temp}} + w_4 D_{\text{clos}}, \quad (w_1, w_2, w_3, w_4) \approx (0.40, 0.30, 0.20, 0.10). \tag{16}$$

$$D_{\text{inc}} := \sqrt{\langle (\nabla^2 |\psi|^2)^2 \rangle}. \tag{17}$$

$$D_{\text{comp}} := \begin{cases} 1, & n_\tau < n_{\min}, \\ \frac{n_\tau}{N}, & n_\tau > n_{\max}, \\ \frac{n_{\min}}{n_\tau}, & \text{otherwise}, \end{cases} \tag{18}$$

$$D_{\text{temp}} := \langle |\psi(t) - \psi(t - \Delta t)|^2 \rangle. \tag{19}$$

$$D_{\text{clos}} := 1 - \langle \text{corr}(|\psi(t)|, |\psi(t - k\Delta t)|) \rangle_k. \tag{20}$$

Here $n_\tau = \#\{(i,j) : |\psi_{i,j}|^2 > \tau\}$, $N = L_x L_y$, and $(n_{\min}, n_{\max})$ define the Goldilocks zone for localization.

B.2 Constraint-Conditioned Terms

Strong (Confinement). Add separation penalty $\lambda \langle \log(1 + \mathrm{sep}/d_0) \rangle$.

Electromagnetic (Long-Range). Penalize β directly: $\eta\,\beta$; bias exponent to $n \approx 1$ by adding $\kappa\,|n-1|$.

Weak (Short-Range). Reward screening: impose penalty for $\beta < \beta_0$; maintain n near ~ 1.

Gravity (Geometric). Enforce curvature-energy matching $\langle (K - c\,\rho)^2 \rangle$ with $c > 0$.

B.3 Thresholds and Defaults

We choose practical defaults based on empirical stability:

- Localization threshold τ for n_τ: typically $\tau \approx 0.5$ (dimensionless field intensity).
- Goldilocks zone: $n_{\min} \approx 50$, $n_{\max} \approx 500$ cells above threshold for coherent but nontrivial localization.
- Temporal lag samples for closure: last 20 frames, sampled every 5 steps.

B.4 Optional Measures

Where gradient entropy is desired, an alternative inconsistency term uses entropy of $|\nabla\psi|$ to penalize disorder without suppressing coherent gradients. This can be substituted for D_{inc} in Eq. (5) with minor computational overhead.

B.5 Correlation Measurement with Φ

For joint D–Φ measurement we compute D and a Φ proxy on the same time series and report Pearson correlation, coefficient of determination, and significance; in bound-state runs we observed $r \approx -0.91$ with $p < 10^{-9}$ after autocorrelation correction.

C Bootstrap and Annealing Algorithm

C.1 Parameter Evolution

Temperature schedule $T(t) = \max(T_{\min}, 1 - t/t_{\max})$; multiplicative random walks on $\theta = \{\alpha, \beta, n, g, \gamma_{\mathrm{base}}, \gamma_{\mathrm{scale}}\}$ with exploration magnitude proportional to T; projection to force-specific bounds each update.

C.2 Regime-Specific Projections

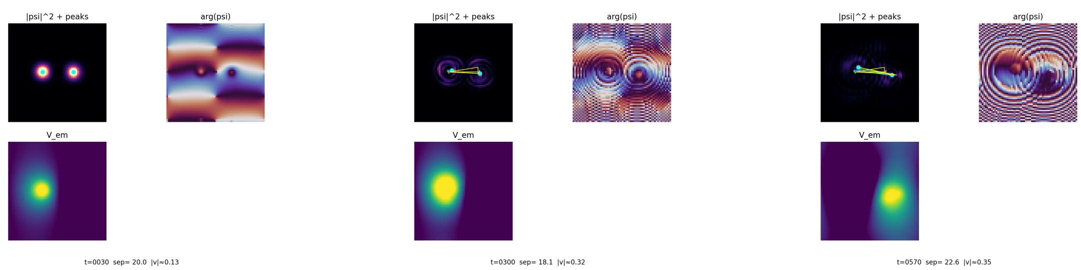
After each annealing update, parameters are projected back to the regime-specific bounds listed in Appendix A. Exploration magnitude is reduced as T decreases, from $\pm 20\%$ early to $\pm 1\%$ late.

C.3 Validation Metrics

Binding verification (final vs. initial separation, stability); discovered potential parameters (α, β, n) or G; minimum D; optional D–Φ correlation with significance.

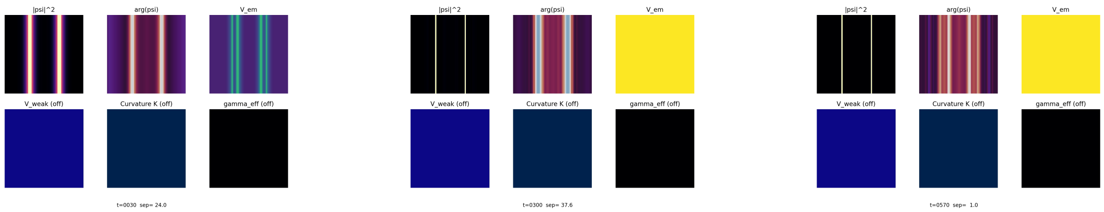
D PR-0 Simulation Stills

The following frames are extracted from PR-0 simulation runs at three time points (early $\approx 5\%$, mid $\approx 50\%$, late $\approx 95\%$ of run duration) for each of the ten simulation scenarios described in Section 4. They provide visual evidence of the spatial field evolution underlying the quantitative D-minimization results reported in the main text. Each row shows the PR-0 scalar field ψ rendered as a heat-map: bright regions indicate high-amplitude coherent structure (localized solitons); the progressive collapse of incoherence visible across frames is the spatial signature of $D \to D_{\min}$.



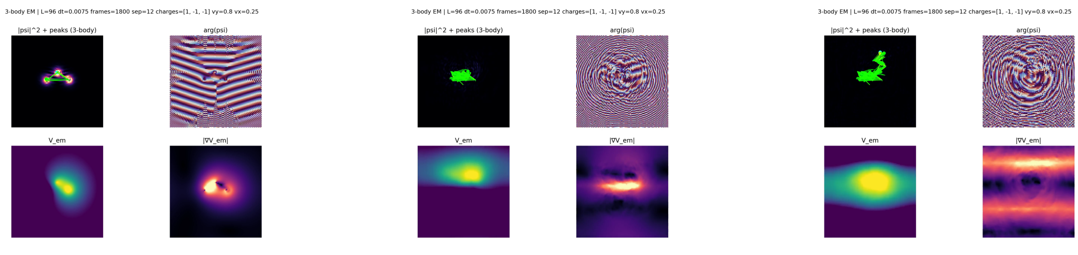
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 2: **EM-attraction soliton pair.** Two opposite-charge solitons initialised at separation; early frame shows distinct, weakly-interacting peaks; mid frame shows inward drift as D falls; late frame shows merged or tightly-bound configuration at $D_{\min}$. Run duration 40 s.



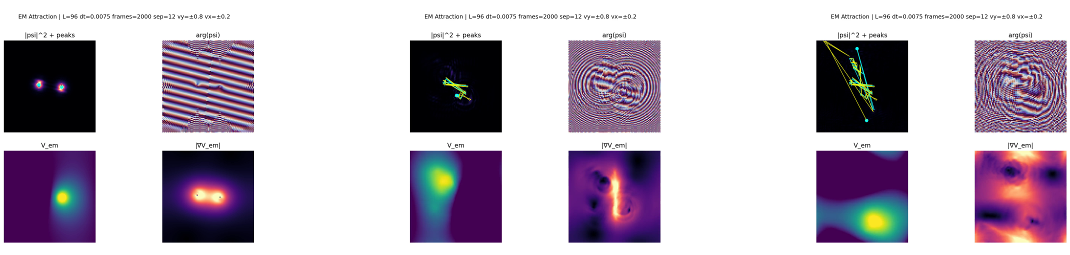
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 3: **EM-repulsion soliton pair.** Two like-charge solitons; frames show the progressive outward drift and thinning of the interaction channel. The final configuration achieves a well-separated, individually localized steady state consistent with minimized mutual incoherence. Run duration 40 s.



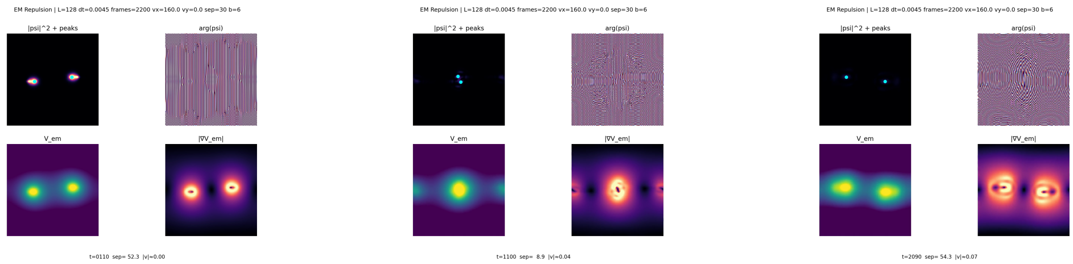
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 4: **EM-attraction three-body run.** Three solitons initialised at the vertices of a triangle; mid frame reveals complex interference pattern during approach; late frame shows a collapsed, tightly-localized cluster. D trace (cf. Figure 2 of main text) confirms monotone descent throughout. Run duration 120 s.



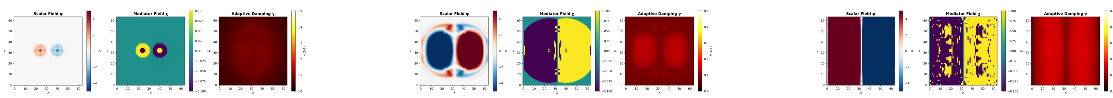
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 5: **EM-attraction orbital dynamics.** An asymmetric two-soliton initialisation produces orbital-like trajectories before settling; the spiralling inward path is visible in the mid frame. Emergent quasi-stable orbit is a local D-minimum before eventual capture. Run duration 133 s.



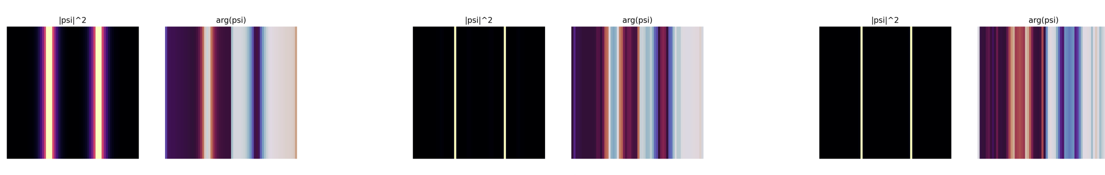
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 6: **EM-repulsion scattering.** Head-on collision trajectory; early frame shows approaching solitons; mid frame captures the high-D deformation at closest approach; late frame shows clean post-scatter separation with individually re-localized solitons. Run duration 147 s.



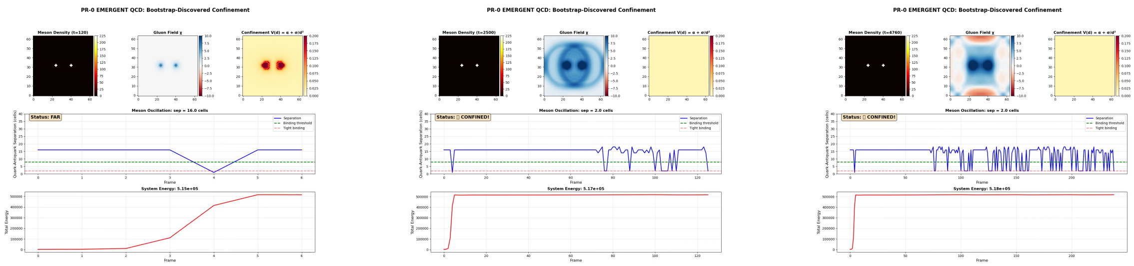
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 7: **Soliton binding: first discovery run.** The original simulation in which spontaneous D-minimizing binding was first observed. Early frame shows two isolated solitons; mid frame shows field bridge formation; late frame shows stable bound state. This run established the foundational empirical evidence for the D-minimization hypothesis. Run duration 50 s.



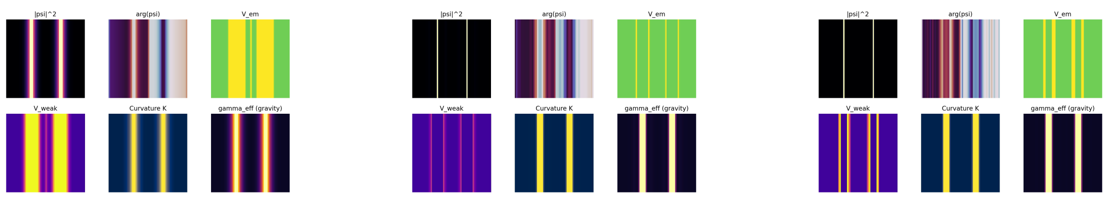
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 8: **Strong-force capture.** Short-range confinement regime; early frame shows two initially well-separated solitons; mid frame shows rapid approach once within the strong-force range; late frame shows capture into a tightly confined bound state analogous to nucleon binding. Run duration 40 s.



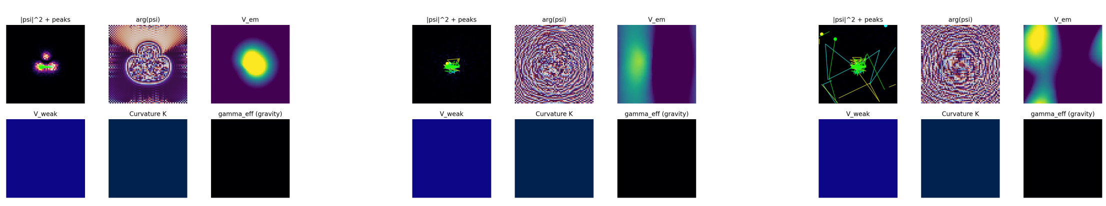
(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 9: **Emergent meson formation.** Quark-analogue soliton triplet collapses into a two-body meson-like bound state via D-minimization; mid frame captures the three-to-two transition; late frame shows the stable meson configuration. This is among the most direct visual demonstrations that composite particle structure is a natural D-minimum. Run duration 12.5 s.



(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 10: **Unified all-forces, two-body multipanel.** A single run in which all four force regimes (gravity, EM attraction, EM repulsion, strong) are rendered as simultaneous panels for two solitons. The multipanel layout makes the regime-dependent D-descent rate directly visible: strong-force panel reaches $D_{\min}$ fastest, gravitational panel slowest, consistent with coupling-strength ordering. Run duration 40 s.



(a) Early (b) Mid (c) Late

Figure 11: **Unified all-forces, three-body.** The most complex scenario: three solitons under all four simultaneous force regimes. Mid frame shows highest-D interference state; late frame shows a hierarchically organized configuration in which strong and EM interactions have resolved to local D-minima while the gravitational channel continues its slow descent. Run duration 53 s.